

CORNELL JOHNSON

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT CORNELL JOHNSON

Johnson at Cornell has deployed a number of sweeping initiatives over the past few years, including a re-vamp of its curriculum and the launch of a new NYC campus. It also merged the business school with its schools of Applied Economics and Hotel Administration, enabling Johnson to pool resources, increase student choice and open new channels for collaboration.

Johnson puts a premium on small class size, engaged professors and its close-knit community. It combines business fundamentals with a strong emphasis on applied learning, individually focused study, leadership development, and intense collaboration. Yet the class is also wrapped in the academic universe of Cornell University, the largest Ivy League in the US, located in upstate New York.

Johnson's new dual campus identity allows MBAs to decamp the cloistered college town of Ithaca for a semester in NYC, drawing comparisons to INSEAD's dual campuses in Fontainebleau and Singapore. Currently housed in Google's Chelsea office, the NYC-based Cornell Tech campus relocated in 2017 to a two million square foot facility on Roosevelt Island. The program features a one-year tech-driven, studio-structured curriculum where students operate in cross-functional teams to develop solutions for nearby tech giants, with resources to commercialize their ideas.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Accounting, Corporate Social Responsibility/Ethics, Tech

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	13	-	19	9	-	11	6	8
Financial Times	7	7	8	7	-	8	7	7
Forbes	-	14	-	8	-	9	-	11
The Economist	6	3	5	5	-	7	10	6
US News	7	7	7	7	-	7	7	6

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	3540	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	283	Avg GMAT	721
Admissions selectivity	18%	Avg GPA	3.52
Yield	45%	% International	35%
Total Tuition	US\$123,0'	% Women	37%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Technology	33%
Consulting	25%
Finance	15%
Consumer / Retail	10%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Adobe, Amazon, Bain & Company, EY-Parthenon, BCG, Cisco, Deloitte, The Clorox Company, Google, L.E.K. Consulting, McKinsey, PwC, Visa

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$137,819

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 93%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR CORNELL JOHNSON APPLICATION

BY RANDALL SAWYER

Randall served as Assistant Dean of Admissions, Financial Aid and Inclusion at Cornell's The Johnson School. During his tenure, Randall and his ADCOM team reviewed and decided nearly 15,000 applications; increased the school's GMAT average and median beyond 700-threshold for the first time ever; enrolled a record number of women and under-represented minorities; and experienced the best selectivity and yield results in the history of the school.



Through the essays, the Admissions Committee is seeking to uncover the less visible forces that shape candidates' lives, opportunities, decisions, and character.

1

ANSWER THE QUESTION

This seems like a simple notion, but many applications are denied because the applicant tells the Johnson Admissions Committee the message they want to get across, and in doing so, sometimes do not answer the question. In those cases, the applicant is already in trouble in the first essay! The best way to make sure you answered the question correctly is to share the body of your answer with a friend you trust and ask them what the question was based on your answer. If they match, well done. If they don't, rewrite until they match! Also, be clear and concise and count words. Candidates have been declined because they could not follow directions.

HAVE A PLAN FOR YOUR SHORT-TERM AND LONG-TERM GOALS

2

Quality in and quality out is important to all b-schools. At Cornell, the Admissions Office and Career Services Office want to make sure that you know where you want to go and how you are going to get there. Everyone knows that ambitions can evolve, but make sure you can draw reasonable lines from what you are doing now through where you will be once you earn your MBA. For example, it is tough to take an IT person and make them an Investment Banker, but the MBA can take the IT person and make them a consultant working in the tech space. Be prepared to discuss this transition in the interview process and have a Plan B if Plan A does not work out.

3

KNOW THE JOHNSON SCHOOL, ITS PEOPLE AND ITS CULTURE.

Cornell is not just building a class; it's building a community. What do you bring to the table to add to that community? The program is based on class discussion, interaction and teamwork. If these three things make you nervous or uncomfortable, don't apply to Cornell. Ithaca, in the bucolic Finger Lakes region of New York state, is a unique place where you'll spend many months, so make sure the location, culture, and community resonate with you. The best way to gauge this is to visit the campus, sit in on a class and speak with Johnson Ambassadors and faculty. Given our current pandemic reality, deploy your virtual networking skills if a campus visit is out of the question. As you do, speak to students and ask them hard questions - politely of course - what they like and don't like, why they chose Cornell, what would they change if they could. You want to get a feeling in your gut about whether Johnson is a fit for you, or not. Trust that feeling and act accordingly. If you feel like it's a mutual fit, then go for it - it is an amazing place for the right people. Cornell knows it isn't for everyone and they're ok with that.

BE AUTHENTIC, BE AUTHENTIC, BE AUTHENTIC.

4

Write the application in your own voice, not someone else's. Accept advice from others who look at your application, but don't let them edit your work until it has lost your voice or style.

Tell the Johnson AdCom about you and your life, career, passions and why you are interested in Cornell. Do not tell them what you think they want to hear. Be honest, forthright and professional - Cornell is looking for those people.

5

BE CREATIVE ON THE BACK OF THE RESUME ESSAY/POWERPOINT/VIDEO.

This is an opportunity to be you without many boundaries. Be unique, tell a story, draw/take a picture, make a video, stand-out with something funny, scary, honest, vulnerable, extraordinary. For example, one applicant's video made the difference by displaying a dazzling unique differentiator: While his application was solid, his experience was typical, but when his training as a classical pianist was revealed in a video performance, he surprised everyone on the team (no one would have guessed it). Not only did he get in, I remember the video more than a decade later. Another memorable essay was submitted by a soldier stationed in a war zone, who provided the chapter headings for a book of his life. It was written to his two daughters, as if he was not returning from war. It was vulnerable, profound and creative, bringing everyone who read it on the AdCom to tears, which left us eager to meet him in person. Johnson is giving you the opportunity to make this part of the application anything you want it to be.

ESSAYS

In addition to considering a candidate's academic and professional background in the admissions process, Cornell Johnson places a strong emphasis on personal characteristics and is looking for students who will be involved in the school and community.



For in-depth essay analysis visit the Fortuna [blog](#).



DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
October Round	08 October 2020	18 December 2020
January Round	05 January 2021	09 April 2021
April Round	08 April 2021	01 June 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

